



for Hestor and Alexandra, and the experience clearly left an impression.

As they stepped into Wankhede, Hestor paused, taking in the electric atmosphere. "It's such a great vibe! Are we allowed to take some pictures and videos?" she asked, her excitement unmistakable.

Once assured, she eagerly captured everything — the sea of blue jerseys, the rhythmic chants, the sheer energy that defines an IPL evening.

Hestor, the sister of former South Africa captain, the late Hansie Cronje, has travelled to cricket venues across the world. Yet, this visit felt special.

"We have heard so much about the Wankhede Stadium, and it was wonderful to be here!" she said warmly.

Alexandrea nodded in agreement before the family made their way towards the Garware Pavilion, ready

to watch some of the game's biggest stars light up another unforgettable night.

Shayan Acharya

Between fire and frost

Going from Chennai to Jaipur in summer is akin to being tossed from a pressure cooker to a frying pan.

While Chennai's heat is a suffocating embrace of humidity, Jaipur's is a searing slap of dryness.

Unlike in Chennai, the wind is not your ally in Jaipur. Any movement in an open vehicle comes with a barrage of hot air that is quick to sap you.

Dreading a long wait in such conditions, the Diary headed to the Sawai Man Singh Stadium for the IPL 2026 game between Rajasthan Royals and Sunrisers Hyderabad quite early. In fact, the Diary was the first reporter to reach the press box — a feat it had never achieved in its

Thermal whiplash: Jaipur outside burns, inside freezes — the press box at the Sawai Mansingh Stadium finds its own extreme, somewhere between survival and satire. PTI

four-year career.

The Jaipur press box is a curiosity — oddly shaped, poorly positioned, and perhaps the most spatially challenged the Diary has encountered in its IPL travels.

Adding to the 'charm' was an air-conditioning system that was working on hyperdrive. The contrast between the raging summer outdoors and the freezing conditions indoors was startling.

With the press box soon turning into a shivering mess, the journalists collectively uttered a combination of words that Jaipur isn't used to hearing: "Please turn down the AC."

While some are dying of thirst, others are drowning.

Pranay Rajiv